G Pay

Helping users understand their spends better

Building Long-Term Trust and Engagement

Agenda

Current Landscape: What's broken and Why Solve now

About Google Pay

Google Pay is a **digital payments** platform that enables users to make UPI, card, and bill payments, send/receive money, and manage **everyday financial transactions** securely.

Why solve for behavioral reflection NOW?

- With digital payments now **habitual**, growth shifts from acquisition to repeat, **reliable** usage
- When users understand **where and why** they spend, they self-regulate better → **high quality engagement**
- Research[1] shows financial awareness demonstrate better **self-regulation,** positioning payment apps uniquely:
  point of spend action + reflection insight

How it helps Google Pay?

Given that UPI payment adoption has been maturing, long-term retention is the key

CLV = UPI Frequency × Merchant Reuse × **Retention Months**

Key players and what they provide

G Pay · super.money · CRED · Paytm · PhonePe

Feature category	What it looks like / typical output
Core payments	Instant bank-to-bank transfers, QR pay, tap-to-pay, send/receive money
Transaction feed	Transaction feed & passbook
Category summary/chart	Monthly/category totals, pie/line/bar charts
Bill payments & reminders	Due-date alerts, auto-detect bills, one-tap payment for bills/subscriptions
Investments & savings	SIPs, mutual funds, goal trackers, invest-from-app flows

What's broken currently

Lack of behavioral context: Insights stop at "what" (you spent X on Y) and rarely explain the **why** (e.g., one-off event, habit, etc.)

Actionability is weak: Where actions exist, they tend to be short-term (e.g., budgeting) rather than driving **sustained habit change**.

Limited identity framing: Most interfaces treat finances as periodic data to be reviewed (monthly/annual) rather than part of an **evolving life goal or identity**

[1] European Economic Letters

Target User Segment and current user journey

Target user segment

The chosen target segment is **working professionals** living in **Tier-1** and **Tier-2** cities in the age group of **22-30**

Why this segment

Market Size → 33.8 million (Approx.)

This is the age group where **emotion driven spending** happens the most

65%[2] GenZ and Millenials say:

Ease, availability, instant rewards, or deals and social influence spark spontaneous splurges (Credit card-led payments)

This cohort is not valuable just because of payments, but because it is the best entry point for **long-term credit, wealth, and habit formation.**

Current user journey map on the app

Bio	Scenario	User Expectations
Anthony is a 24 y.o. PM living in Bangalore who's a foodie and very fashionable	During the month, he makes uses the app to make multiple payments for food and shopping	He expects he will be prudent financially, keep track of expenses regularly and save more

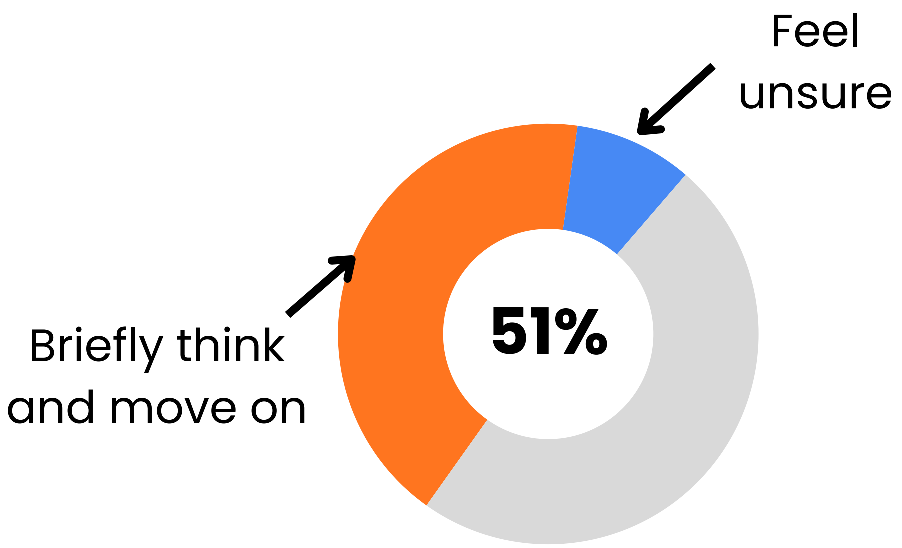
Steps

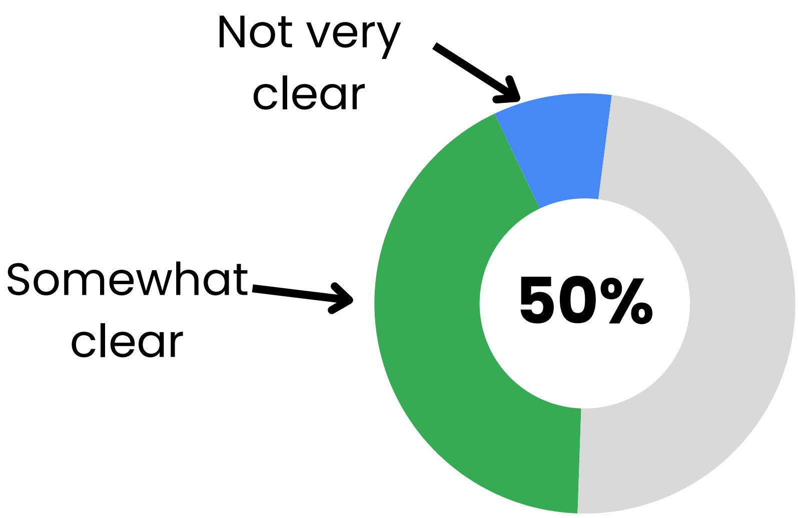
Pay via UPI/card | Payment notification | Category view on homepage | Transaction history view

- Start of the month - salary received, Anthony is excited
- He opens the app to make payments and food for shopping
- He gets multiple notifications of transactions done
- Mid-month, he sees multiple categories on app and gets confused
- End month review leaves him surprised, when he sees he had overspent

User Persona and problem validation

Insights from the survey (Total respondents, n = 33)





Think briefly and move on or feel unsure and reflect after making a spontaneous purchase

Are somewhat clear or not very clear on **WHY** they spend more in a given month

Food (84.8%), **Shopping** (45.5%), **Travel** (36.4%) - category spend

57.6% Were surprised how small expenses add up

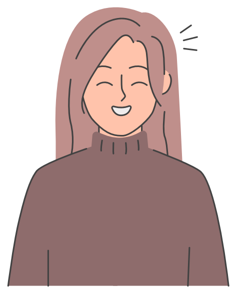
22% reviewed their finances end of the month

28% reviewed only when something felt off

Key Takeaways

- Users often feel **overwhelmed** when trying to understand how they spent when they look at **everything together**
- Uses do try to **think about** their **spontenaous** purchases but miss out on considering and **reflecting** on it later
- Frequency of review is often **erratic**

User Persona



Neha, 25

Marketing manager working in Pune

Pain Points

- Forgets reviewing expenses on a regular basis
- Gets confused when reviewing statements end of the month
- Overwhelmed when trying to figure why certain exepnses piled up to exceed the budget

Goals and Needs

- Wants to feel more in control of her expenses
- Review her finances regularly
- Be able to put pieces together without spending hours to understand where she spent and why

Recall Walkthroughs

“” I had purchased an expensive badminton racket, but since I didn't go to play i forgot about it and was surprised month end when I exceeded budget “”

“” Eating out doesn't take a toll at once, but when I see the cumulative spend at the end, I feel a bit guilty “”

Problem Framing: What is the problem and why Gpay should solve for it

What is the true problem

1. **Behavioral Awareness:** Many users aren't aware about their own spending behavior
2. **Reviews without context:** Current expense statements give data, but not the context
3. **Financial Behavior Unchanged:** Without needed clarity, users are unable to change how they manage expenses meaningfully

Why solve now

- With higher **credit availability** and easier payment modes, **spontaneous spending** based on offers and credit is rising
- With multiple payment apps, users can **switch** apps based on offers, but building **trust** by making user more **self-aware** ensures **long-term retention**
- A recent CIBIL report says, Gen Z form **41%** of new-to-credit (NTC) consumers in India, signifying importance of the cohort

Who faces the problem

Working professionals between the age group of **22-30**, living in **Tier-1** and **Tier-2** cities where the there is high tendency to:

- Spend impulsively
- Reflection avoidance
- Erractic expense review

How do we know it's a real problem

51% Think briefly and move on or feel unsure after spontaneous purchase
47% review spends **monthly** (20.6%) or when **something feels off** (26.5%)
50% somewhat clear (38%) or **not very** clear (12%) why they spent more

- Moreover, **guilt** and **avoidance to reflect** came up when asked for recalling past spontaneous purchases

Value Generation

For Users

1. **Clarity** over confusion when it comes to spend reviews
2. Long-term **financial prudence** by compounding habit
3. **Contextual** insights making data **actionable**

For Business

1. With UPI adoption peaking, **long-term retention** wins
2. Better user understanding → **higher trust** → conversion to **high-margin** products (credit)
3. Habitual insights → **reduced churn** for low-frequency payers

Possible Solutions: Bridging the gaps

Expense Copilot

What is it

A chatbot that answers user questions about their spending using text and simple visuals, with suggested questions.

Problem it solves

Users have data but don't know what to ask or how to interpret patterns

How it works

- Uses UPI transactions, categories, amounts, time
- LLM + rules-based analytics for safe, explainable insights
- Pre-built question prompts (trends, comparisons, recurrence)

Why it matters

Low effort self-reflection and builds trust through clear, data-backed answers

Outcome

- Higher insight discovery
- Engagement beyond transactions

Reflection Flashcard Tree

What is it

A weekly, opt-in, gamified reflection experience where users answer 3 short questions about recent spends and earn rewards.

Problem it solves

Evidence shows users don't have complete clarity on their spends, they either think briefly and move on or feel unsure

How it works

- Uses Historical transactions, categories, week/month aggregates
- Weekly AI generated questions and AI summary
- Gamification and rewards
- Weekly insights after completion
- User opt-in control

Why it matters

Encourage awareness in a playful and non-judgy way to reduce emotional resistance and build sustainable habit

Outcome

- Higher trust and emotional safety
- Better understanding of spending triggers
- Long-term engagement

In-Moment Spend Insight

What is it

A lightweight insight shown after significant spends (₹500+), with optional emotion tagging

Problem it solves

Overspending is driven by habits and emotions noticed too late.

How it works

- Shows recent category trend after transaction
- Optional emotion input (single-tap)
- Reuses past emotions for similar future spends

Why it matters

Creates awareness at the moment of action without blocking or shaming

Outcome

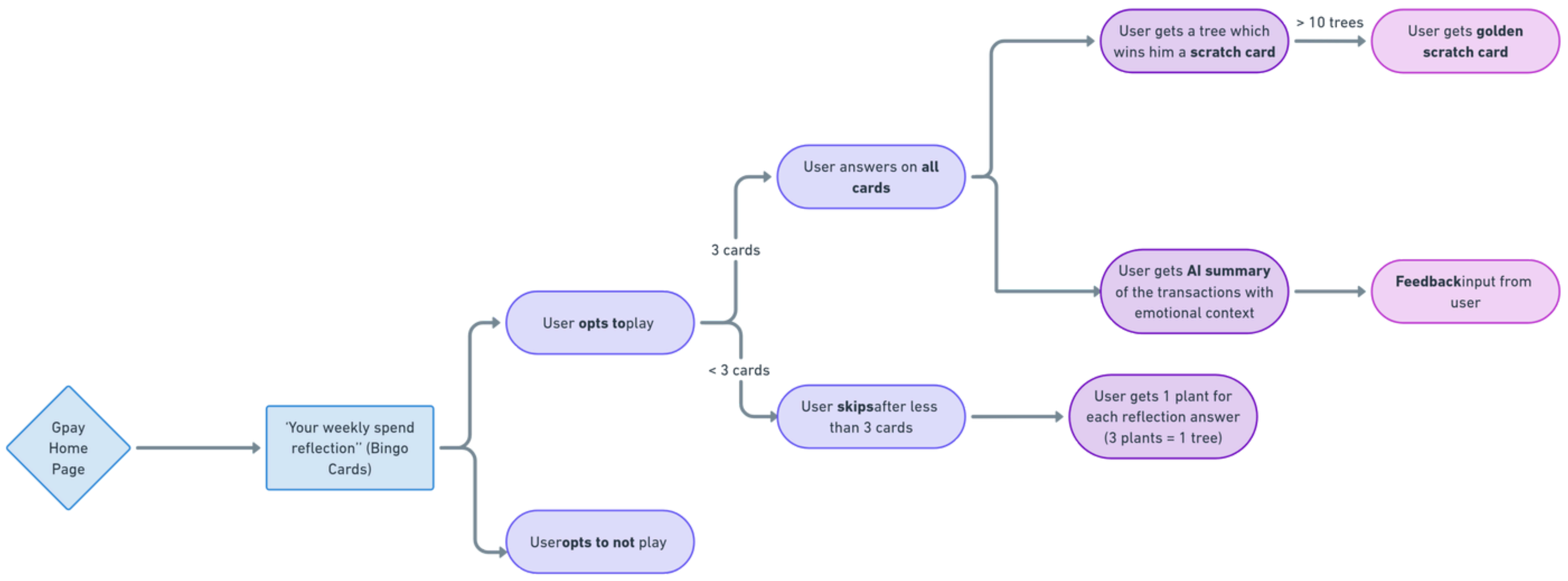
- Higher self-reported awareness
- Reduced repeat overspend in emotional categories, long-term trust

Solution Prioritization and winning solution analysis

Solution Prioritisation

Solution	Emotional Safety	Trust Impact	AI Feasibility	Overall Score
🌱 Reflection Bingo Tree	8	8	8	512
Conversational Expense Copilot	7	7	6	294
In-Moment Spend Insight	4	5	6	120

User Flow



Why Reflection Flashcard Tree?

Emotional Safety (8/10)

- Reflection is framed as play, not correction
- Casual language + optional participation prevents shame
- Gamification rewards engagement, not spending restraint

Trust Impact (8/10)

- User reflects after the fact, on their own terms
- No interruption of core payment flow
- Positions Google Pay as a companion, not a monitor

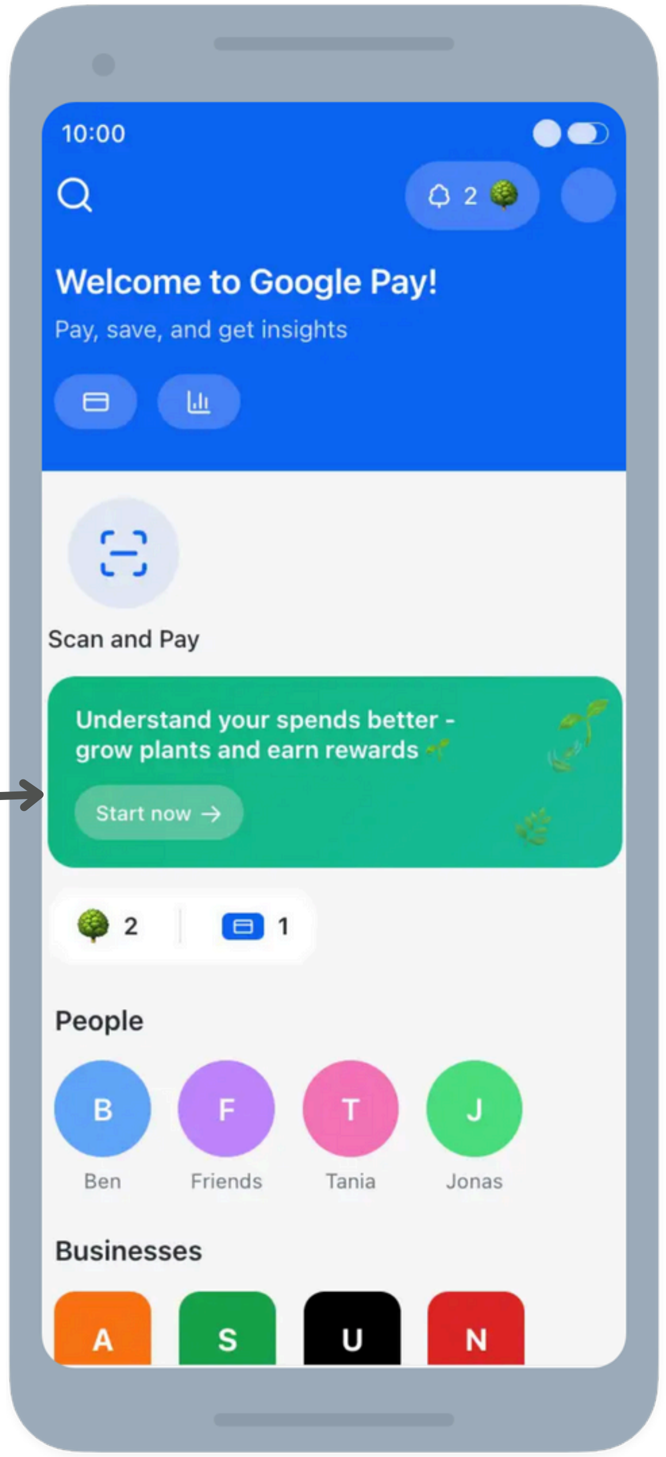
AI Feasibility (8/10)

- AI generates lightweight, bounded questions (not judgments)
- Weekly cadence avoids real-time pressure and errors
- Insights are aggregated and summarised, not inferred per transaction

Wireframing: making reflection light + playful to increase awareness and motivation

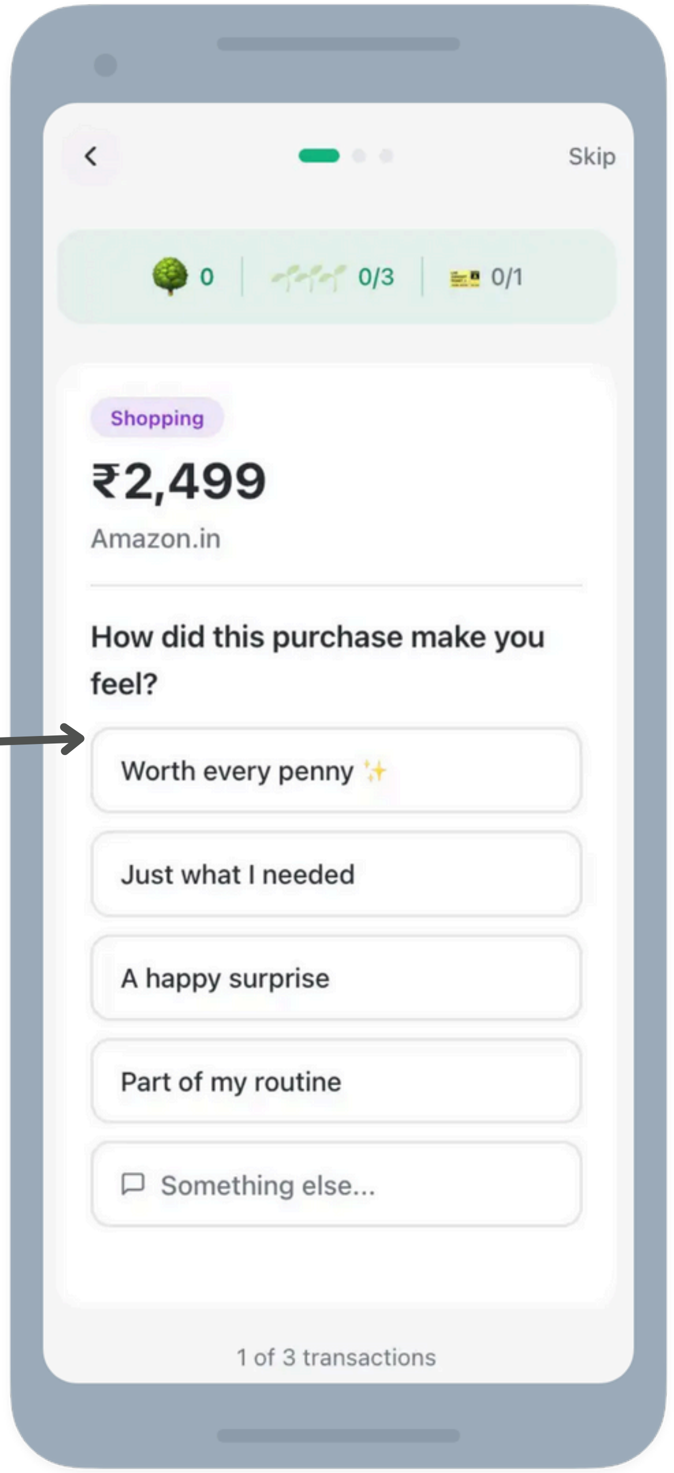
Prototype

Home Screen



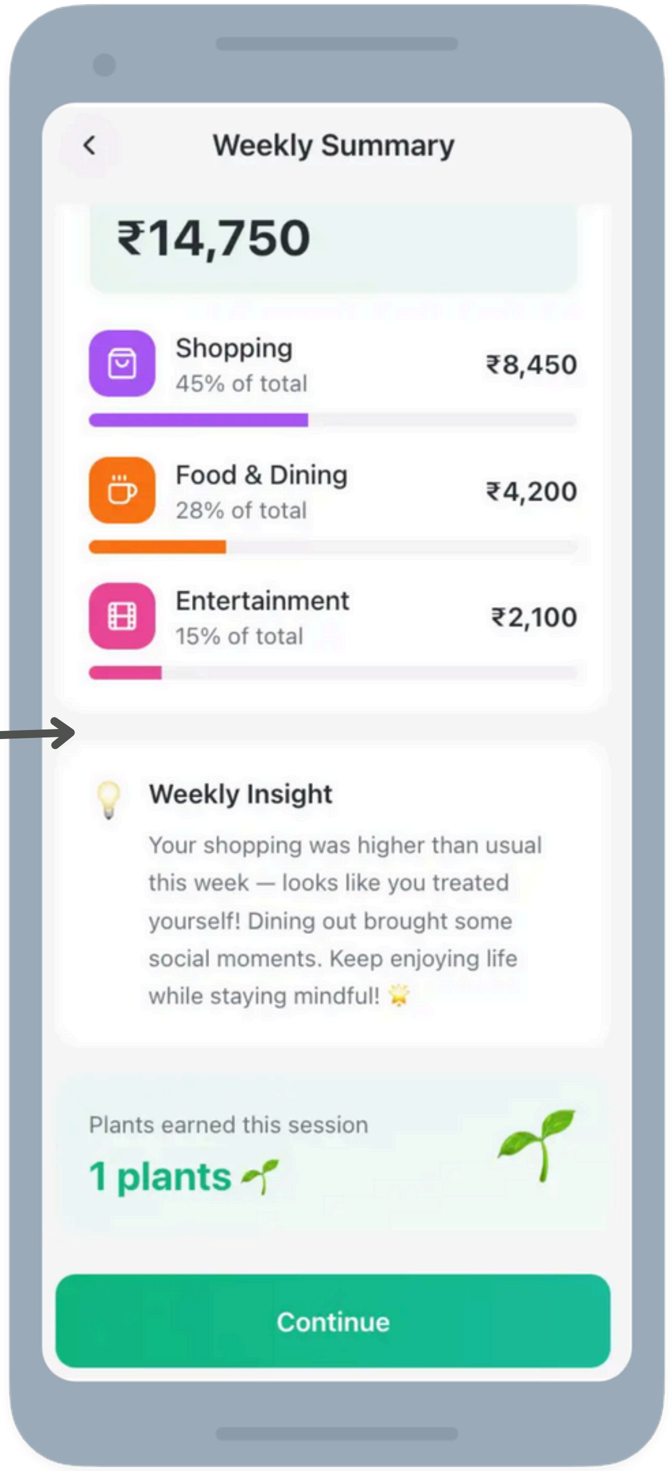
Discovery of the feature on home page along with **rewards** won

Flashcard Questions



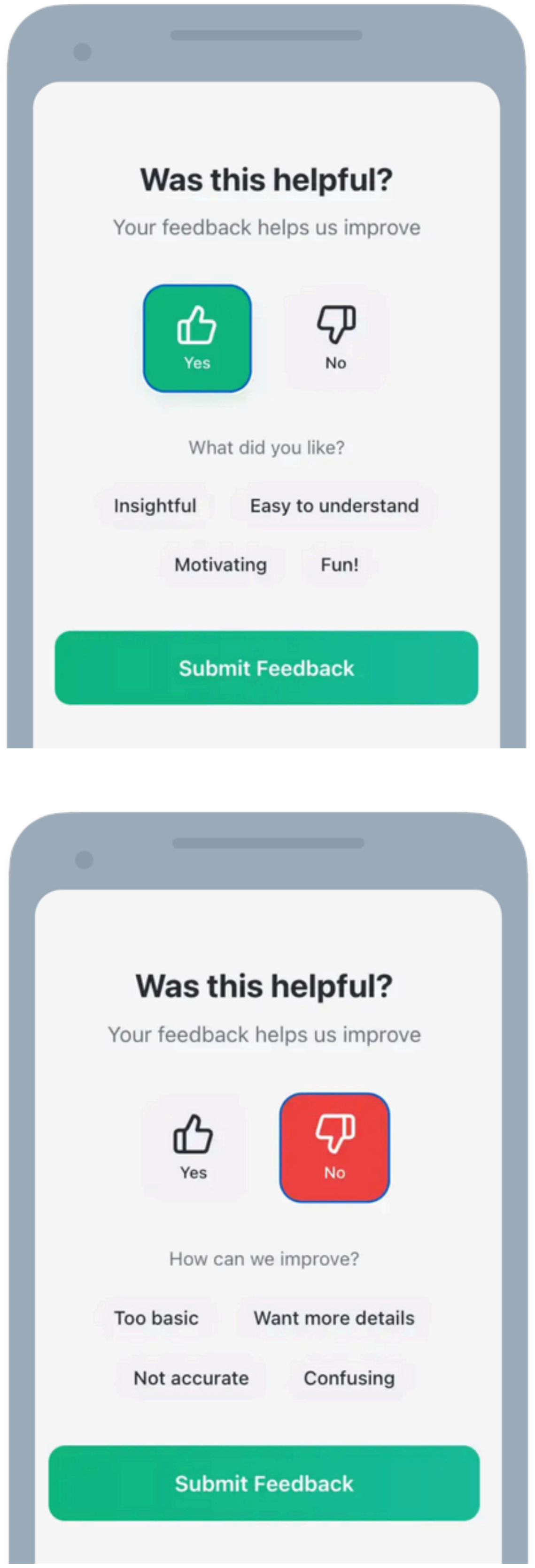
AI generated questions based on spend type to bring out **emotional recall** and **reflection**

Weekly summary

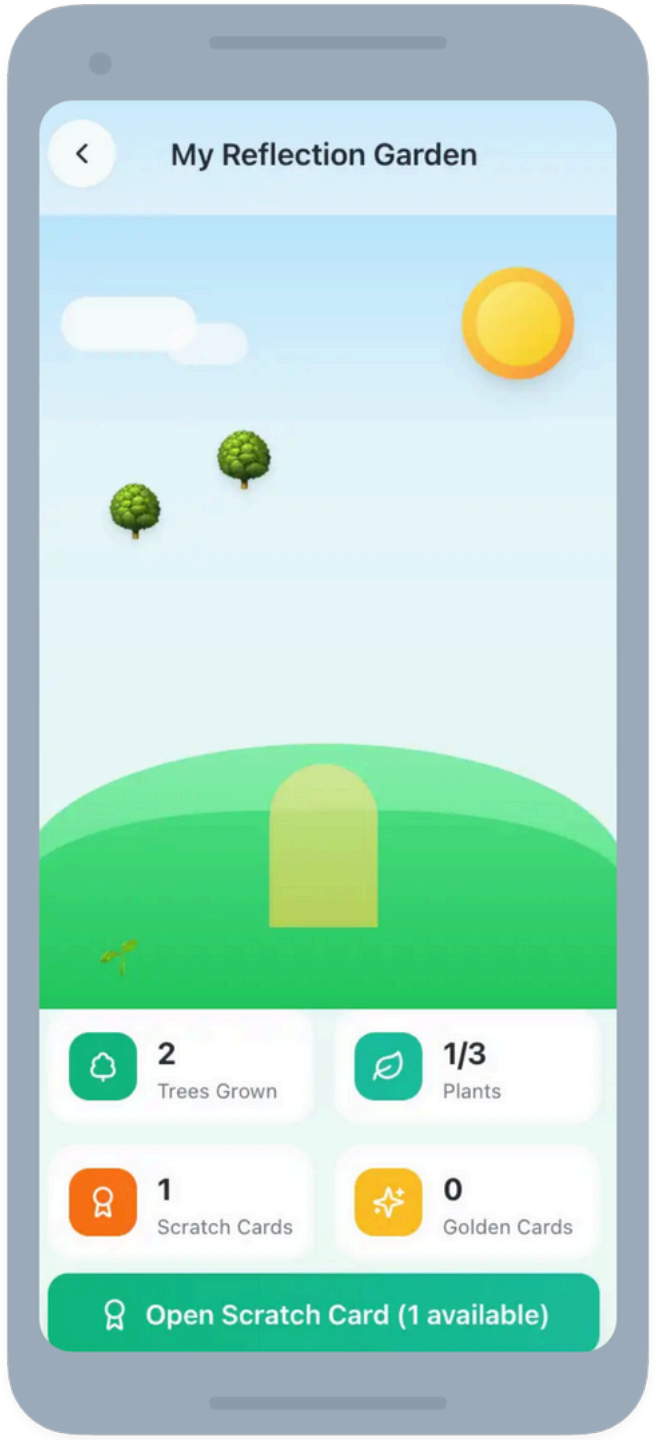


After reflection questions, insights and summary presented which now make **sense** like a **story**

Feedback mechanism



Rewards and progress



User gets to see their **rewards**, measure their **progress** in terms on trees grown

Key Metrics: tracking feature success

NSM Weekly Reflection Completion Rate (WRCR)

Definition: % of WAU who complete ≥ 1 full "Tree" (3 reflection questions) & view their Weekly Insight Summary

Adoption: The user's willingness to engage with the prompt
Engagement: Their follow-through on all three questions
Value/Trust: Delivery of the actual insight

Category	Metric Name	Definition / Formula
Adoption	Feature Discovery Rate (FDR)	(Users who tap the Bingo entry point / Weekly Active Users) x 100
	First Reflection Activation Rate	Users answering ≥1 reflection on first exposure ÷ feature entrants
Engagement	Weekly Active Reflectors (WAR)	% WAU answering ≥1 reflection question in a week
	Insight Consumption Rate	% of users who started playing that view the weekly insight summary
Retention	Golden Card Progression	% users who have successfully grown 5+ trees over their lifetime.
	4-Week Reflector Retention	% of reflectors active in week 4 after first reflection
Business	Merchant Reuse Lift	Δ merchant reuse rate for reflectors vs non-reflectors
	Retention Delta	The difference in 30-day GPay app retention between reflection-engaged users vs. non-engaged users.
AI/Guardrail	Question Skip Rate	% of AI questions skipped by users (High skip rate = Low AI relevance or poor tone).
	Trust Signal Score	negative insight feedback rate indicates poor insight quality/questions

Managing Risks & GTM

Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Why It Matters	Mitigation
Feels judgmental	Even soft guilt breaks **financial trust**	Non-judgmental language guardrails, curiosity-based framing, balance between positive & neutral spends
Gamification > reflection	**Low-quality answers** weaken insights	Light friction (micro-pause), reward variation over speed, keep rewards visually secondary
Generic insights	"I already know this" kills **credibility**	Cross-week pattern synthesis, named behaviors
Frequent skipping	No data → no **value loop**	Smarter timing, rotate question types
Wrong spend highlighted	**Misalignment** erodes system trust	User override ("Is this worth reflecting on?"), anomaly detection, category cooldowns
Privacy anxiety	Silent **disengagement**	Clear "not for ads" contract, easy deletion

GTM & Launch

Phase 0: Internal + Dogfood (2-3 weeks)

Who: Internal Google Employees
Objective: Validate tone, question quality, emotional safety

Phase 1: Power Users (4-6 weeks)

Who: Top 1% power users (transaction frequency) who already use Gpay a lot
Objective: Open rate, Completion vs Skip rate, make refinements

Phase 2: Rollout with ongoing experiments

Who: All Gpay users
Objective: Cohort analysis, growth

GTM:

- In-app post transaction nudge after top spend of the week
- Contextual (conversational) notifications

Growth

- Allow users to share tree growth with contacts
- Smart reminders (soft tone, no push)